

Late June 2026
To Members of the Press
Fox2E Studio Co., Ltd.

Chronology of Events Relating to the Payload CDx Joint Research Proposal

— A Record Concerning a Biomarker Proposal for Patient Selection in DXd-ADC Therapy —

■ Overview

Fox2E Studio Co., Ltd. (Headquarters: Nagano, Japan; Representative Director: Yusuke Yokouchi) announces that, in late June 2026, it published on its official website materials concerning the chronology leading to this press release regarding the “Payload Companion Diagnostic (“Payload CDx”) Joint Research Proposal,” which was submitted on May 8, 2026 to the Open Innovation Office (the “OI Office”) of Daiichi Sankyo Co., Ltd. The publication is made from the public-interest standpoint of patient safety and the efficient allocation of medical resources.

This press release summarizes a series of events relating to an external scientific proposal based solely on publicly available data. The joint research proposal has also been published in a form suitable for third-party review and verification.

The following two materials are published on Fox2E Studio’s official website, and this press release includes an overview of the chronology:

- The Joint Research Proposal
- This Press Release

■ Proposal

Fox2E Studio proposed a Payload Companion Diagnostic (Payload CDx) as a biomarker for patient selection in antibody-drug conjugates carrying the DXd payload (DXd-ADCs).

The principal features of the proposal are as follows:

- It incorporates a public-interest perspective, including patient safety and the efficient allocation of medical resources.
- It is based solely on publicly available data, including PubMed and KAKEN.
- It is presented in a form suitable for independent third-party review and verification.
- It expressly discloses that the proposer was formerly employed by Daiichi Sankyo Co., Ltd. from 2007 to 2018, for a total of 11 years.
- The proposal has been published in advance on Fox2E Studio’s official website.
- It states that the proposer has no conflict of interest.

■ Purpose of the Publication

Fox2E Studio positions this proposal as a matter of public interest relating to patient safety and the efficient allocation of medical resources. Accordingly, the company has determined that organizing and disclosing this chronology, for the purpose of ensuring an accurate record and enabling third-party verification, serves the interests of cancer patients, the clinical community, and the pharmaceutical sector as a whole. The facts concerning this matter have been organized after confirming their consistency with the original email correspondence and the contents of the proposal.

This publication is intended to achieve the following:

- To provide a factual record that enables society to discuss how externally submitted scientific proposals are received and considered within pharmaceutical companies.
- To present, in a form suitable for third-party verification, issues concerning patient safety, the efficient allocation of medical resources, and the social implementation of scientifically verifiable medical technologies.
- To record, in a form suitable for future independent verification, that a scientific proposal existed which may help avoid, as far as possible, administering treatment to patient populations unlikely to respond, thereby potentially contributing to improved patient safety and the appropriate allocation of medical resources. This is particularly relevant as high-cost cancer therapies become widely used and society at large, including cancer patients, healthcare professionals, and taxpayers, may not always have sufficient opportunity to learn about the existence or verifiability of companion-diagnostic candidates that could more precisely predict therapeutic effect.

Fox2E Studio does not seek to solicit a one-sided evaluation regarding whether the proposal should be adopted. Rather, based on the publicly disclosed facts and scientific materials, the company welcomes constructive verification and discussion by third parties, including healthcare professionals, researchers, members of the press, patient organizations, policy and regulatory stakeholders, and members of the pharmaceutical industry. This publication is not intended to criticize any particular company or individual.

■ Chronology (May 8 – Late June 2026)

Date	Key Developments
May 8	Fox2E Studio formally submitted the joint research proposal to the OI Office, including a request that it be handled, as necessary, as a matter for consideration at the management level.
May 21	Fox2E Studio received a reply from the OI Office declining to pursue the proposal, citing a lack of alignment with its research priorities and strategic direction.
May 26	Fox2E Studio sent inquiries seeking confirmation of the official position and of the responsible party.
June 1	Fox2E Studio received a reply from the OI Office stating that, following review by the relevant internal departments, the response constituted the official response of Daiichi Sankyo Co., Ltd.
June 3	Fox2E Studio shared in advance a draft chronology intended for publication and requested prior confirmation by the relevant legal department(s).
June 8	Fox2E Studio received a reply from the OI Office confirming that there were no discrepancies regarding the contents of its May 21 and June 1 replies. The reply did not contain any express statement as to whether confirmation by the legal department(s) had taken place. Nor did the reply identify any specific factual errors, requests for correction or deletion, or requests to halt publication regarding the draft chronology.
June 8	Fox2E Studio inquired whether the reply had undergone confirmation by the relevant legal department(s).
June 9	Fox2E Studio received a reply from the OI Office reiterating that all responses provided to date constituted the official responses of Daiichi Sankyo Co., Ltd., with no change to that point. As to whether the reply had undergone confirmation by the relevant legal department(s), the OI Office stated that it would refrain from responding, on the grounds that the matter pertained to details of the internal review process and confirmation procedures.
June 11	Fox2E Studio published the proposal and the draft press release in advance on its official website, shared them with the OI Office, and requested that review by the legal, public relations, and management functions, among others, be considered as necessary.
Late June (planned)	Scheduled distribution of the official press release.



■ Declaration on Conflicts of Interest

Fox2E Studio and its representative hereby declare that they have no current financial, contractual, or other conflict of interest with Daiichi Sankyo Co., Ltd. in relation to the Payload CDx technology.

■ Published Materials

URL: https://www.fox2e.com/research_patent.html

■ About Fox2E Studio Co., Ltd.

Company name: Fox2E Studio Co., Ltd.

Representative: Yusuke Yokouchi, Representative Director

Headquarters: Nagano, Japan

Established: 2025

Business: Research and development of AI-related technologies; independent research on technology proposals with public-interest value, among others.

Website: <https://www.fox2e.com>

Representative Director Yusuke Yokouchi worked as a researcher at Daiichi Sankyo Co., Ltd. from 2007 to 2018, for a total of 11 years. After a period of independent activity following his departure, he established Fox2E Studio Co., Ltd. in 2025. The company conducts research on AI-related technologies and technology proposals with public-interest value.

■ Inquiries Regarding This Matter

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Inquiries from members of the press are accepted by email. When contacting us, please include your name, affiliation, contact details, and the nature of your inquiry.

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